This last column is written by the magistrates themselves. I saw in it—often "excuse"—sometimes, "make up in next piece"—sometimes, "to work alone," "to bread and water"—seldom, "to rasping logwood." The daily allowance is two pounds of bread; some soup of beans, peas, etc., with wheaten bread in it; and, except Friday and Lent, half a pound of cold meat. Each prisoner has also the value of our farthing, for which he can buy near two pints of small beer; or somewhat else which the victualler of that prison is allowed to sell, and deliver to them at a wicket in the wall. Spirituous liquors are expressly prohibited: and so is wine, unless it be ordered by a note from the physician. It is not allowed to give anything directly to the prisoners: but there is a box into which money may be put; and at stated times it is equally distributed among them. Cards, dice, and all gaming are strictly forbidden: and there are excellent rules for preventing all quarrelling; mending their morals; preserving their health; and making them for the future useful in society. To transcribe all the rules would to most readers be disagreeable. Such as wish to see them will find them, together with more particulars of this noble institution, in two edicts printed in folio at Ghent in 1773 and 1775; both in French and Low Dutch: and in a book in quarto written by Count Vilain XIV and offered to the Government in 1775. The title of it is *Mémoire sur les Moyens de corriger les Malfaiteurs et Fainéans à leur propre Avantage et de les rendre Utiles à l'Etat.*

I revisited this prison in 1778 with one of the magistrates, and found that they were still carrying on a well-regulated manufactory. There were two hundred and eighty men prisoners, and one hundred and seventeen women. These latter had on the house clothes, and were at work. Most of them were spinning or knitting, ranged in proper order, attentive and quiet. I was informed that all the prisoners were allowed one-fifth of their earnings for themselves. I brought home specimens of the cloth, as I did of the paper from Brussels; which I mention, because I know an idea has prevailed, that no manufacture can be carried on by convicts to any valuable purpose.

I have been very particular in my accounts of foreign houses of correction, especially those of the freest States, to counteract a notion prevailing among us, that compelling prisoners to work, especially in public, was inconsistent with the principles of English liberty; at the same time that taking away the lives

of such numbers, either by executions, or the diseases of our prisons, seems to make little impression upon us. Of such force is custom and prejudice, in silencing the voice of good sense and humanity!

The number of criminals in December 1781, was two hundred and six. They were spinning, weaving, making nets, making and mending clothes, or working in the bakehouse and kitchen; and appeared clean and healthy. The doors of the bedrooms were open while they were out in the daytime, and none of the rooms were in the least offensive. In another quarter, the number of petty offenders was a hundred and six, who were employed in the same manner with the criminals above-mentioned; except some who worked as carpenters, turners, and smiths, for the use of the house. On the women's side there were a hundred and fifty, who were washing—spinning—making and mending the linen—or at work in the kitchen. Their bread, soup, and meat were good and plentiful, and all bespoke the care and attention of the director. A list of such prisoners as behave well is annually sent to the emperor (about Good Friday): in 1782 twelve received their pardon. If, however I venture to point out some defects in so good an institution, that others may avoid them, I hope to be excused. The building has too many stories—the rooms and corridors are too low—the infirmaries are not sufficiently detached—there are not proper workrooms, and those are some steps underground—the women have not separate dormitories—the sewers are improperly placed—the distribution of provisions, being but once a day, is not frequent enough—and the bowls, being of wood, cannot easily be kept clean.

At my visit in 1783, I found here a great alteration for the worse; the flourishing and useful manufactory destroyed; and the looms and utensils all sold, in consequence of the emperor's too hasty attention to a petition from a few interested persons. That which ought to be the leading view in all such houses is now lost in this house. Many formerly ascribed the comfort and happiness of their lives to the trades they here learned, and the attention here paid them; but now, the men and women (the former three hundred and twenty-six in number and the latter a hundred and fifty) do not earn, one with another, seven farthings a day. Their victuals are also reduced; the meat from half a pound to six ounces, and greens from three to two farthings-worth a day. Their bread, made in the house, is now ammunition bread. In consequence of this vile policy I